



PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Protecting Yourself and Your Organization

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CODEALPHA CYBER SECURITY INTERN
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WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a cyberattack method that tricks victims into revealing sensitive information by pretending to be a trustworthy person, company, or service.

It is a form of social engineering that targets both individuals and organizations. Phishing commonly arrives through email, text messages, or fake websites designed to appear legitimate.

Attackers use deception to encourage people to share passwords, payment details, or other confidential data.

HOW PHISHING WORKS



1. ATTACKER SENDS A DECEPTIVE MESSAGE
2. An attacker impersonates a trusted person or organization and sends a convincing email, SMS, or other message.



1. VICTIM OPENS AND CLICKS
2. The recipient opens the message and is persuaded to click a malicious link or download an attachment.

1. DATA IS STOLEN OR MALWARE INSTALLED
2. The attacker captures credentials or sensitive data, or installs malware on the victim's device.

TYPES OF PHISHING



Spear phishing

Targeted messages aimed at a specific person or organization, often using personal details to appear credible.

Whaling

A high-value form of spear phishing that targets executives or other senior leaders.



Clone phishing

A legitimate email is copied and modified to include a malicious link or attachment.

Vishing

Phishing conducted through phone calls or voice messages.

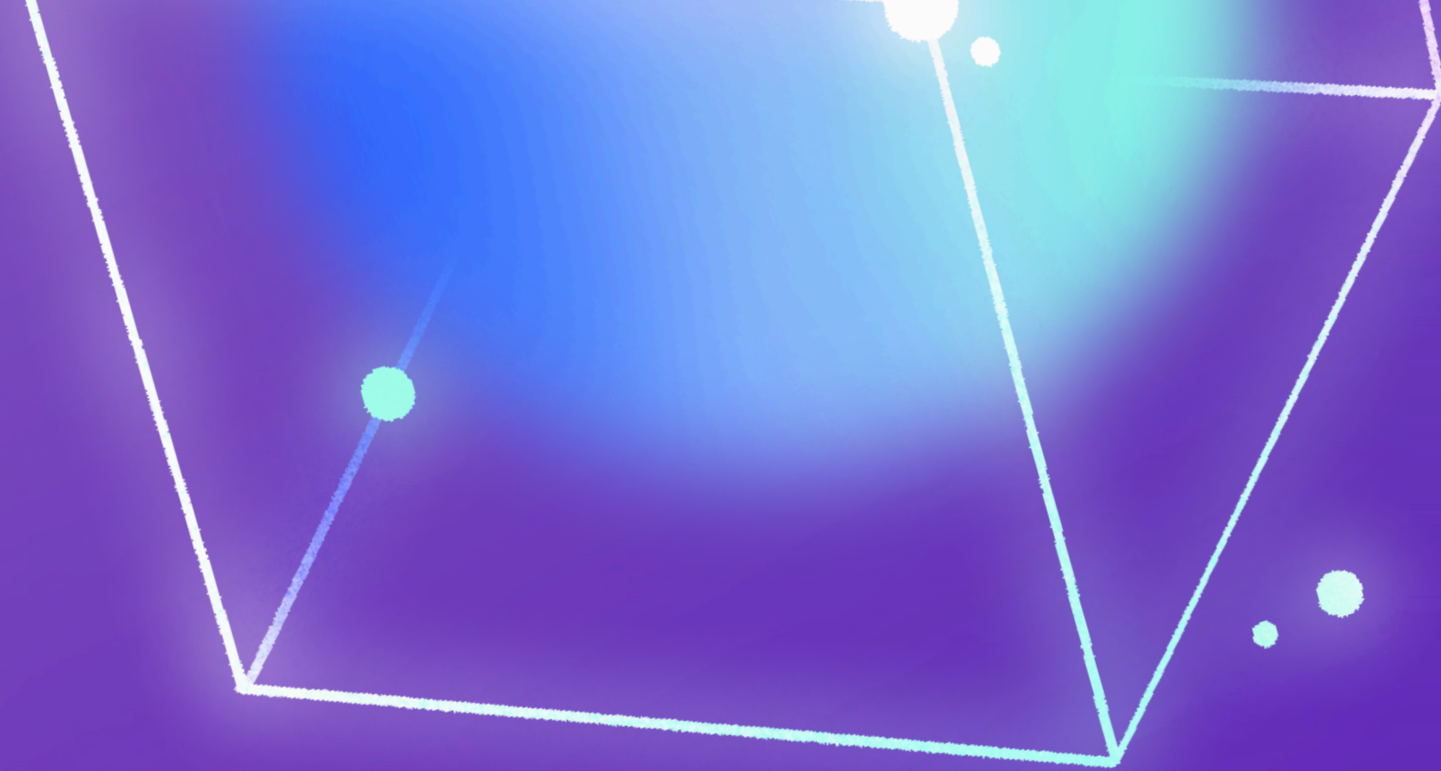
Smishing

Phishing delivered through SMS or text messages.



Remember: phishing attacks can arrive through email, phone calls, or text messages. The more targeted the message appears, the more carefully you should verify it before responding.

IDENTIFYING PHISHING EMAILS



Watch for unexpected senders, suspicious email addresses, urgent or threatening language, and poor grammar or spelling. These warning signs often indicate an attempt to make you act before you can verify the message.



Never trust mismatched URLs, suspicious links, or unexpected requests for sensitive information such as passwords or credit card details. Verify the sender through a separate, trusted channel before taking action.

IDENTIFYING FAKE WEBSITES

- Check the URL carefully for misspellings, unusual characters, or odd domains. Look for HTTPS and a valid security certificate before entering any information.
- Be cautious of poor design, inconsistent branding, or unexpected login pages. Avoid clicking links from unsolicited messages; open the official site directly instead.

SOCIAL ENGINEERING

HOW ATTACKERS MANIPULATE TRUST

Manipulating emotions

Phishing messages often trigger fear, urgency, or curiosity to push people into acting quickly. Attackers may pretend to be a boss, bank, or IT department and demand immediate action, payment, or account verification.

Exploiting trust and helpfulness

Attackers rely on our instinct to help people we trust. For example, someone impersonating IT support may ask for a password or verification code. Pause, verify the request through a separate channel, and never share credentials.



? Phishing Attack Scenario

A finance employee received an urgent message appearing to come from the company's director. After clicking a convincing login link, the employee entered credentials on a fake sign-in page. Attackers used the stolen access to enter the mailbox, redirect invoice payments, and expose sensitive customer information. The incident caused financial loss, operational disruption, and a data breach. Key lesson: verify unusual requests through a separate trusted channel, inspect links carefully, and report suspicious messages immediately.

HOW TO STAY SAFE



Never click suspicious links or open unexpected attachments. Check the sender's full email address and verify unusual requests through a trusted channel before responding.



Use multi-factor authentication (MFA) on important accounts. Keep your operating system, applications, browser, and security software updated to reduce vulnerabilities.



Report suspicious emails, messages, and links to your IT or security team. Reporting quickly helps protect colleagues and strengthens the organization's defenses.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU CLICKED A PHISHING LINK



Disconnect immediately from the internet if possible. This can limit unauthorized access and reduce further damage.



Secure your accounts
Change passwords for affected accounts, starting with your email. Use strong, unique passwords and enable MFA.



Scan, report, monitor
Run a full antivirus or malware scan. Report the incident to IT or security, then monitor accounts for suspicious activity.

QUIZ

Email Security

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PHISHING AWARENESS QUIZ

Test your instincts and discuss your answers with the group

Q1. Which is a common sign of a phishing email?

- A. Urgent language or a suspicious sender
- B. A normal greeting
- C. A familiar company logo

✓ Answer: A

Q2. True or False?

You should always trust an email just because it appears to be from your CEO.

- A. True
- B. False

✓ Answer: B — False

Q3. Which is NOT a phishing technique?

- A. Vishing
- B. Smishing
- C. Securely verifying a request through a known channel

✓ Answer: C

Q4. What should you do with an unexpected attachment?

- A. Open it immediately
- B. Forward it to a friend
- C. Verify the sender through a separate trusted channel before opening

✓ Answer: C

Q5. What does STOP → CHECK → VERIFY → REPORT mean?

- A. Pause, inspect, independently confirm, and report suspicious activity
- B. Click, download, login, and continue
- C. Ignore all messages

✓ Answer: A

**STOP → CHECK → VERIFY →
REPORT
STAY VIGILANT. PROTECT OUR
ORGANIZATION.**

